

Say-Mean-Matter

Say-Mean-Matter helps students question a text, search for deeper meanings, and make connections between the text and their lives. **Choose one of these famous quotes to try this strategy:**

“Anyone who stops learning is old, whether at twenty or eighty. Anyone who keeps learning stays young.” <i>Henry Ford</i> Founder of Ford Motor Company	“Education is the most powerful weapon which you can use to change the world.” <i>Nelson Mandela</i> Activist	“Never let the fear of striking out keep you from playing the game.” <i>Professional baseball player, Babe Ruth, who held the homerun record for 34 years</i>
“None of us is as smart as all of us.” <i>Ken Blanchard</i> American Author	“The important thing is not to stop questioning.” <i>Albert Einstein</i> Physicist	

With your partner:

SAY What does the text say? Direct quote, paraphrase, or summary	MEAN What does this information mean? Make an inference. Interpret and “read between the lines.” • What does the author mean? • How can the information be interpreted? • What can be inferred? • What point is the author making?	MATTER Why does it matter? So what? What are the implications and/or possible outcomes? • Why does this information matter? • Why is this important or significant? • What are the implications or consequences of the information? • How does this connect to other ideas?

Now try another quote on your own:

SAY What does the text say? Direct quote, paraphrase, or summary	MEAN What does this information mean? Make an inference. Interpret and “read between the lines.” • What does the author mean? • How can the information be interpreted? • What can be inferred? • What point is the author making?	MATTER Why does it matter? So what? What are the implications and/or possible outcomes? • Why does this information matter? • Why is this important or significant? • What are the implications or consequences of the information? • How does this connect to other ideas?

Reflection:

How did it feel to use the Say-Mean-Matter strategy? How did the steps extend your thinking about the quote and the meaning of the quote?
